the rapes and murders and defiling of mosques, was untrue. He said that he was a regular at the local mosque to offer *namaz*, and he had never been harassed. All these factors contributed to his decision to surrender. After hearing all this, I recommended to the GOC that we should take the chance. Now that we knew what he looked like, it would be easier to apprehend him the next time around. We got the go-ahead and Samra went back to his 'home' in Umarabad Colony, barely three km away.

Over the next year or so, Samra continued to give us hard intelligence. We were careful to use him sparingly; we didn't want to kill the goose that was laying the golden eggs. Even when we had pinpoint intelligence, so-and-so house in so-and-so locality, we made a big show of carrying out the complete battle procedure. Cordoning off a set of houses and randomly searching them before zeroing in on the target house. This was once to have an unfortunate outcome because in one instance, while 'pretending' to question the owner of the house, the terrorists who were hiding in an underground hide opened fire through the floor of the house, grievously injuring Narendra, who fired back despite his injuries, killing the two terrorists below. He too, was later awarded the Sena Medal (Gallantry). In one operation carried out in the heart of Srinagar, we even killed a fair-skinned Canadian terrorist. These operations were over and above the other operations that we were carrying out by the traditional methods. Intercepts between the various tanzeems and particularly between the LeT itself, warned everyone to stay out of the 2 RR areas. It was recognition of the fear we had instilled in the minds of the terrorists. Of course, it was too good to last. The LeT carried out their own analysis and reached the only possible conclusion. One day, when Samra was out for an evening walk with his sister-in-law, he was gunned down by motorcycle-borne gunmen in the

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